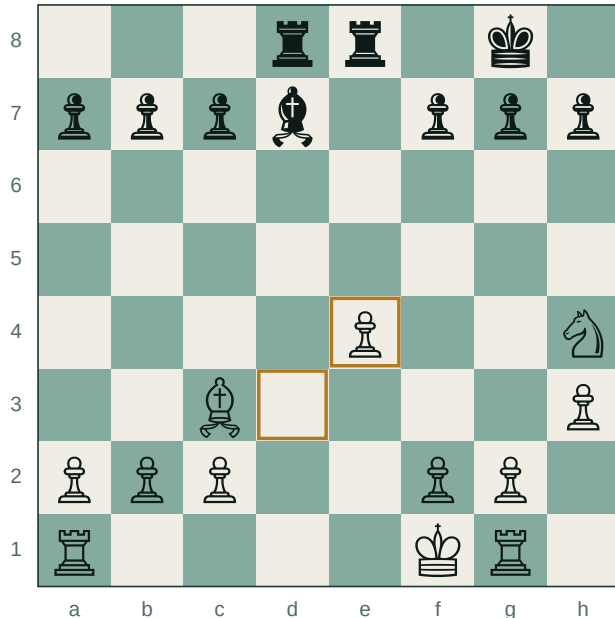


# Intermediate moves: Black, move 19

Intermediate moves

Black to move



Previous move: 19.dxe4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**19...Bb5+ 20. Ke1 Rxe4#**

**19...Bb5+** Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **20.Ke1**.

**20...Rxe4#** Mate: rook on e4 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on e1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on e4. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

The postponed recapture may disappear. The intermediate move must win enough or preserve the right to recover material.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

An intermediate move interrupts an expected sequence with a stronger immediate threat. Instead of recapturing automatically, use a check or another forcing move to change the result.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Before every routine recapture, scan checks, queen attacks, and mating threats. Return to the original capture only if it still helps.

The defending king is on f1. Geometrically undefended: knight on h4 and rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.